

a Agreement $\neq$ termination

the real probe stream of one trajectory

The answer is still moving.

Stopping on agreement destroys a recovery the trajectory would have made on its own.

10 × "37" ✗ "46" ✓ to the end



consensus fires at 256, on "37"

harm : rescue 45:1 → 2:1

can any
rule be
safe and
saving?

b 3,520 rules, gates fixed in advance

preregistered sweep on frozen trajectories

18 frozen environments

2 models × 3 benchmarks × 3 seeds



three preregistered gates

Ⓒ drop ≤ 1.0 pp saving ≥ 10%

Ⓑ drop ≤ 2.0 pp saving ≥ 20%

Ⓓ drop ≤ 3.5 pp saving ≥ 30%

0 / 3,520 clear any gate

is early
exit itself
impossible?

c Early exit is not the problem

same sweep, gates and accounting

consensus
do recent probes
agree?

DEER
confident at a
reasoning boundary?

same sweep · same gates · same
accounting

✗ **consensus** 0 of 3 gates

✓ **DEER** 3 of 3 gates
-0.3 pp accuracy @ 28% tokens saved

Early exit is possible — **self-consensus** is what cannot make it safe.